

CHILD OF LIGHT

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Ubisoft's recently launched RPG Child of Light is artistic and thoroughly enjoyable – and not as lengthy and time-consuming as most other role playing games. The game is a side-scroller Role-Playing game borrowing elements from classic Japanese RPGs. The game vaguely represents the Trine series in form but its visuals are more rustic and are made to look hand-drawn and painted.



The Story

The game starts with its lead character - Aurora - a princess of 1980s Austria lost in an alternate dimensional dark world called Lemuria. The tale starts off with her as a lost child awakening in Lemuria, as she takes on her quest to restore the light - the sun, moon and stars - in Lemuria which have been taken away by the Dark Queen Umbra. But her main goal is to find her way back to her father, The Duke. She is joined in her quest by the unlikelyst of companions. Like a willow-the-wisp called Igniculus, a pair of rickety jester siblings, a rapier-bearing mouse with dreams of grandeur and a bumbling wizard (of course). Child of Light has a story that would take you back to the age of fairy tales. The entire story consists of eleven chapters and a very nostalgic fairy-tale story.

The Gameplay

Being a side-scroller, one would not expect the kind of detail and intricacy that Child of Light delivers. At first glance, it may seem childish with its character and storyline. And the game as a whole is admittedly not very difficult by modern standards of RPGs like Dark Souls or even other JRPGs like Final Fantasy and Septerra Core, but it would be a good reworking of games of the likes of Final Fantasy VII. The French game creators at Ubisoft Montreal show a vast knowledge of the JRPG genre, but twist it into something new with the story and



artwork. The incorporation of obscure side quests, for example, require you to be alert throughout the game, for you never know when a background character's comment may be the key to finishing a quest.

The combat in the game (for what is an RPG without kids slicing and dicing monsters) is turn-based – a tedious process for some, but for someone who's grown up in the heyday of RPG games, its not very daunting. Using the trope of 'Oculi' to infuse your attacks with additional elemental damage, or simply boosting your health, defense or attack is also a classic.

The controls are also interesting. In addition to the keyboard controls, the mouse is used to control Igniculus, whose main purpose is to blind enemies (both in and out of battle).

The puzzles in the game aren't very challenging, but do require acclimatization of the gamer into the artwork that is the world of Lemuria.

Narration, Visuals and Atmosphere

One of the interesting features of the game is the narrative structure. The entire narration of the game is in a rhyme scheme. Something that plays into the game itself. Rhyme in the game is considered the polite and proper way of talking. For example, when the jester Rubella shows her inability to rhyme (and talk almost normally), other characters interject to correct her (and do so within the meter). The world's equivalent of 'comic relief'.

The game holds you in with the visuals and general atmosphere. The attention to detail is commendable. The artwork is intricate and gorgeous to look at, holding your attention through every attack, every boss fight and character dialogue, not letting the game get boring at any point of time.

Bottomline

All-in-all, Child of Light is built in such a way that it is almost impossible to do wrong by it. The game is built for gamers of all ages, and fun for anyone who isn't the kind of gamer who goes AAA-title-hopping for a dose of 'serious' gaming. *

MOAR!

Genre: JRPG-Platformer

Developer: Ubisoft Montreal

Publisher: Ubisoft

Platform: Windows, Playstation, XBOX, Wii

